

1926-2011

Canadian Ernest McCulloch was a hematologist who dreamed of finding a cure for leukemia. When a radiation experiment produced an odd result, he recognized it as something entirely new.

Ernest McCulloch was born and raised in Toronto. He studied medicine at Toronto University and qualified as a doctor in 1948. After a period of time at the Lister Institute, a medical research charity in London, UK, he returned to Toronto and worked as a research fellow in pathology at Sunnybrook Hospital. In 1957, he joined the newly created Ontario Cancer Institute, a research division of Princess Margaret Hospital. There he began the main body of his research into blood formation, both normal and malignant, and soon joined forces with James Till. Their work on stem cells would transform cancer research and give rise to regenerative medicine. During his career, McCulloch was a key figure in Canadian medical research and served on many national and international advisory committees.

MILESTONES

DEPARTMENTAL HEAD

Becomes the Head of Hematology at the newly formed Ontario Cancer Institute in 1957.

PIVOTAL PUBLICATION

Publishes findings of stem cell research with Till and Andrew Becker in the journal *Nature* in 1963.

LEUKEMIA STUDIES

In the 1970s, focuses his stem cell research on analyzing the mechanisms of human leukemia.

NATIONAL HERO

Along with Till, is inducted into the Canadian Science and Engineering Hall of Fame in 2010.

“McCulloch was the ‘big picture’ thinker.”

Tak Wah Mak, 2018

ERNEST

McCULLOCH

